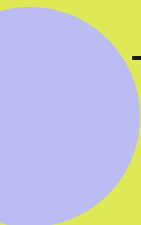




BUY, SELL, GIVE, RECEIVE

# BetterBarter

A one-stop platform for verified Columbia  
community members to **buy, sell, give and receive**  
— from people nearby.



## PROBLEM

# Students already trade with each other. Badly.

### Fragmented Channels

No dedicated one-stop platform for Columbia community members to buy or sell new or secondhand items. Most search or list across Facebook Marketplace, WhatsApp group chats, eBay, or thrift stores.

### Poor Timing & Fit

Buyers may find a cheap item online, only to see pickup is out of reach. Sellers reach a general audience, with no way to find Columbia members nearby.

### No Trust or Verification

For most online transactions, Columbia community members agree to buy or sell to an unverified stranger, sometimes having to reveal their own personal details.

### Waste, Waste, Waste

Buyers may end up paying more for what other Columbia community members may be selling at a cheaper rate. Sellers donate or discard what they cannot sell on time.

# A board that only your campus can see.

## **Columbia-Only Community**

Buy, sell, give, or receive items exclusively from verified Columbia community members. Filter by distance and choose to transact with people who live near you.

## **Built-in Safety**

Chat with other members using only your first name — no phone numbers, no emails, no personal information exchanged. Meet up on or near campus, whatever is safe and convenient for you.

## **Variety & Relevance**

Access new or used items from textbooks and furniture to fashion and baby toys, all from people nearby. We are more alike than we think.

# Deployed, hardened, and open source.

## List it in two steps

Up to three photos, then the details. Category, condition, size, how you are listing it, and where you want to meet — from a list of real campus places, never a room.

## Claim and chat

Claiming opens a thread and holds the item for three hours, so two people are not walking to the same lobby. Contact details are refused at the point of sending.

## Confirm in person

Six digits split across the two phones — three each. Joining them completes the handoff for both sides at once, and is the only thing that counts a reuse event.

**0**

Contact details exchanged  
enforced, not requested

**3h**

Hold on a claim

**7d**

Freshness check  
stale listings pause themselves

**1**

Campus per board  
enforced in Postgres

# Free to students, on every item, always.

## Transaction Fee (Later On)

No transaction fees for items, but 1–5% once we evolve to include services categories e.g., tutoring, babysitting, moving help.

## Boosted Listings

Sellers pay a small, affordable flat fee to bump their listing to top.

## Advertisement Fees

Local businesses (cafes, bookstores, bars, clinics, etc) pay to reach a hyper-targeted, verified Columbia audience.

## Institutional Partnerships

Work with institutions to coordinate donation drives.

## Campus licence · \$15k a year

where the money is

The partnership above, priced. Anchored on a cost the university already carries — move-out hauling, plus the circularity reporting it has to produce anyway — and it buys object-level, auditable reuse data no collection programme can produce. Every projection in this deck is built on this line alone.

# Two ways of counting, both from published figures.

|              | LICENCE REVENUE | OBJECTS MOVED | DERIVATION                                                                              |
|--------------|-----------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TAM          | ≈\$58M / yr     | ≈46M / yr     | 3,896 US degree-granting institutions (NCES) × \$15k · 15.4M undergraduates × 3 objects |
| SAM          | ≈\$18M / yr     | ≈14M / yr     | ~1,200 residential four-year campuses where move-out density makes it work              |
| SOM · year 3 | ≈\$375k / yr    | ≈300,000      | 25 licensed campuses — roughly 2% of the serviceable set                                |

**Target Audience:** anyone with an active @Columbia.edu.

**Industry growth:** universities are under binding waste-reduction targets — Columbia's Plan 2030 among them — and have no object-level data to report against them.

## COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

# Everyone else is either open to the world, or a bin.

| COMPETITOR           | WHAT IT IS                                  | WEAKNESS                                                                                |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Facebook Marketplace | Open marketplace, city-wide                 | Unverified strangers, phone numbers exchanged, travel across the city                   |
| WhatsApp / GroupMe   | Class and hall group chats                  | No search, no history, no reputation — a listing scrolls away in an hour                |
| Give + Go Green      | Staffed campus collection at check-out      | Catches what is left at the end; nothing moves student-to-student before the pile forms |
| Depop / Vinted       | Peer resale, shipped                        | Packaging and postage on a \$10 desk lamp — the emissions cancel the point              |
| <b>BetterBarter</b>  | <b>One verified campus, meet in a lobby</b> | <b>Complementary to collection, and the only one producing auditable reuse data</b>     |

The moat is not the board — a board is a weekend. It is the verified graph plus a confirmation a single person cannot fake.

# Distribution runs through institutions, not advertising.

## Digital Marketing

Orientation and move-out are the two weeks a campus reuse board sells itself. Class GroupMes, hall floors and EcoReps mailing lists reach the whole intake for nothing — a board is only worth opening where a thousand rooms are being filled or emptied at once.

## Strategic Partnerships

Housing, sustainability offices and EcoReps already own both moments and already have the lists. One pilot with data a sustainability office can put in a report becomes the sales collateral for every campus after it.

## Phased Rollout

Columbia first, then campuses that open themselves: a university email domain maps to a campus server-side from a registry of 7,328 academic domains, so a new school's board exists the moment its first student signs in.



# Small numbers, and the assumptions printed next to them.

| YEAR | LICENSED CAMPUSES | REVENUE | WHAT HAS TO BE TRUE                                                              |
|------|-------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | 1 pilot, unpaid   | \$0     | A Columbia pilot runs through the 2027 move-out and produces a defensible number |
| 2    | 5                 | \$75k   | That report converts four more campuses in the same conference                   |
| 3    | 25                | \$375k  | ~2% of the 1,200 serviceable campuses, at \$15k each                             |

### Funding needs

Not capital yet. A pilot campus, an introduction to a housing or sustainability office, and people willing to attack the assumptions in the impact model.

### What it costs to run today

Effectively nothing — a free-tier database and static hosting. The first real costs are daily backups and a support inbox, and both arrive with the first pilot.



# thank you

Let's build the future together.

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